

of the Cabots and the Lodges—not at all like the Capulets and the Montagues of Shakespearean fame. The Cabots and Lodges intermarry frequently. I went to college with a boy named Cabot Lodge. There is even a little poem about them:

Boston, oh Boston, the land of the bean and the cod

Where the Cabots speak only to Lodges

And the Lodges speak only to God!

The Cabots and Lodges probably think of that as a nice little nursery rhyme for their children.

That's a family! They even have a family archives, where family papers dating back to their origins as fur traders are kept.

But, seriously, family culture makes a family strong. You see it all the time. Families that seem to succeed, generation after generation. History is full of them—think of the Borgias! One pope after another. One famous poisoner after another!

We have dear friends who are perfect examples of strong family culture—and they are so successful as a family that we can't bear to read their Christmas letters. After years of hyperachievement, one child is at Harvard, and the other, just to be different, is at Yale! Not only that, both children are regional tennis champions, and my friend, the mother, built a koi pond in the yard by herself. And she rotates the tires on the family car! Yes, I used to hear about that from my husband.

And mentioning my husband's nagging about the car, and the fact that I don't rotate the car tires and that our children—so far—have not gone to Harvard or Yale, brings me to the third point I want to share with you, which I will call very simply . . .

“Love and happiness.”

And that's not just the name of a song I heard Edward singing while we drove to school. It is so trite, yet so true: For the family to survive, it must be a source of happiness to its members. Think about it: If our children have to choose between keeping wealth in the family and the sacrifice that might entail, and taking their share and getting away from a disagreeable atmosphere—well, what would you do?

This issue of family happiness is of particular interest to us because we all know that while a family can be happy without a fortune, an unhappy family will not hold on to its fortune for long. We are talking about how to keep wealth in the family over generations.

I am not trying to say that being from an unhappy family or being unhappy in your family means you can't be extremely successful in your own life. Jacob was driven away from his family tents, and it turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to him. Cain did not do so badly, either, come to think of it.

And I am talking about more than personal happiness. Individuals are not always going to be happy in their lives. And that's probably good. We need to push out beyond our comfort zone if we are going to do something extraordinary with our lives. Even if we are going to move ahead.

But the family has to be a place where the individuals in it can refresh themselves—a sort of green pasture where you can lie down and be refreshed. Where you can let down